

Council Meeting
March 11, 2026
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 11, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of February 25, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

**O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – Abstain**

Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstained

MAYOR'S NOTES

Claremont Parks and Recreation along with the Commission are working on the 8th annual scholarship golf tournament taking place on May 20, currently looking for sponsorships as well as teams.

Claremont youth baseball and softball registration closes tomorrow afternoon.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Celebrate Claremont on July 3rd from 1p-5p leading up to the fireworks at Monadnock Park. The City is looking for volunteers and businesses to participate.

The City received a preliminary report from the SGH engineers – no structural damage due to settling, but there is significant damage to the brick work, to the interior finishes, several options for review will be coming to Council.

Planning a facility tour as the Council requested hoping to do this at the Saturday budget meeting.

PSNH Eversource abatement case update the court has denied the appeal, and PSNH/Eversource will not be challenging the ruling.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

CCTV

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Zachary Haines to Seat 4 of the CCTV Board.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

EPA Multi-Purpose Steering Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Cogswell to appoint Greg Adams to Seat 4 of the EPA Multi-Purpose Steering Committee.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Annette Dauphinals to Seat 4 of the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Parks and Recreation Commission

Mayor Girard noted there were three applicants for Seat 5 at-large: Tina Bergeron, Ken Burke, and Gary Dickerman.

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Ken Burke to Seat 5 of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Gary Dickerman to Seat 5 of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Tina Bergeron to Seat 5 of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – Burke

Cogswell – Burke

Greenrose – Dickerman

Matteau – Burke

Koloski – Dickerman

Limoges – Burke

Hemingway – Burke

Irish - Burke

Girard – Burke

Motion carried 7-2

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Heather Irish to Seat 7 of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – abstain

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstain

Mayor Girard noted there were still two open alternate seats.

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Gary Dickerman to Alternate Seat 3 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Tina Bergeron to Alternate Seat 4 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

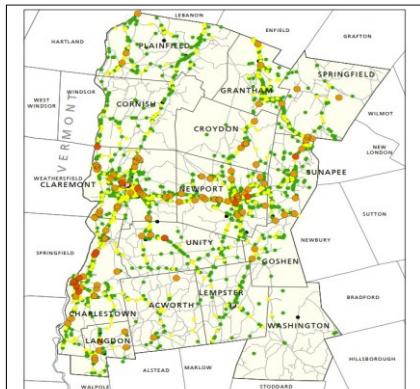
Elizabeth Cram, Ward I, invites the public to the Fiske Free Library to meet Author Duncan Watson on March 25th, at 6pm.

Heather Irish, Ward III, is asking the public for volunteers for upcoming City events, and noted there are different ways to apply like a QR code, or a paper application which can be found at the Parks and Recreation Department.

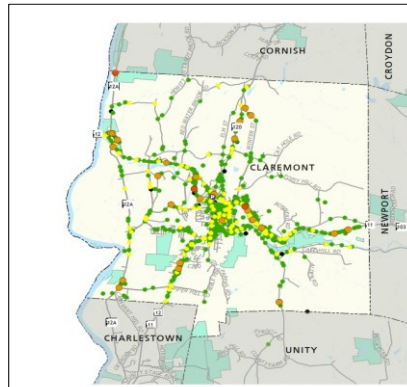
NEW BUSINESS

Safe Streets and Roads For All (SS4A) Presentation

David Derrig with AECOM working with Sullivan County Safer Streets and Roads 4 All shared a presentation



Why Are We Here?



FHWA Safe System Approach



TRADITIONAL	SAFE SYSTEM
Prevent crashes	Prevent deaths and serious injuries
Improve human behavior	Design for human mistakes/limitations
Control speeding	Reduce system kinetic energy
Individuals are responsible	Share responsibility
React based on crash history	Proactively identify and address risks

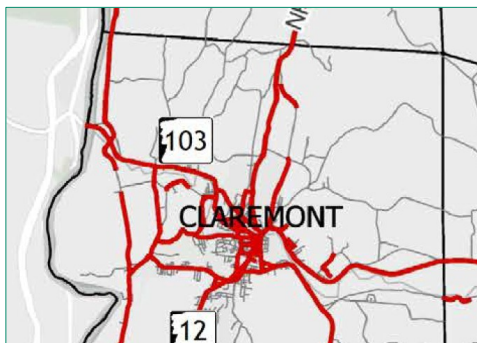
Whereas traditional road safety strives to modify human behavior and prevent all crashes, the Safe System approach also refocuses transportation system design and operation on anticipating human mistakes and lessening impact forces to reduce crash severity and save lives.

The four tiers of the Safe System Design Hierarchy

1
Remove Severe Conflicts: includes countermeasures which separate different roadway users in space
2
Reduce Vehicle Speeds: aims to reduce both the likelihood and severity of crashes
3
Manage Conflicts in Time: includes mainly changes to intersections, such as signal changes
4
Increase Attentiveness and Awareness: relies most on drivers being aware of the situation and behaving appropriately

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High-Injury Network



Claremont

- NH Rt. 103
- Hanover St. (NH Rt. 120)
- W. Pleasant St. (NH Rt. 11)
- River Rd.
- Chestnut St.
- Washington St.
- NH Rt. 12A (Windsor Rd., Jarvis Hill Rd.)
- Plains Rd.
- Industrial Blvd.
- North St.
- Maple Ave.
- Elm St.
- Sullivan St.
- Summer St.
- Lane Ridge Rd.
- Princeton St.
- Charlestown Rd.
- Citizen St.
- Crescent St.
- Dunning St.
- Franklin St.
- Glidden St.
- Green St.
- Middle St.
- Mulberry St.
- School St.
- South St.

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Public Outreach

- 12 events across the county, plus 2 events tabled by other organizations
- Most successful events:
 - Old Home Days
 - Cornish Fair
 - Craftsmen Fair
 - Christmas in July
 - Fall Fest

Online Survey

- Went live in late June
- 320 Responses
- 17 Questions
- 90% Completion Rate

Organization	Date Event/Time
1 Acworth Craft Fair	June 7 9AM-2PM
2 Claremont PRIDE	June 21 9AM-3PM
3 Grantham Old Home Day	June 28 11AM-2PM
4 Newport Farmers' Market	July 11 3PM-6PM
5 Christmas in July - Charlestown (Frank's)	July 19 9AM-2PM
6 Newport Concerts on the Common	July 20 6-8PM
7 Unity Old Home Day	July 26 9AM-2PM
8 League of NH Craftsmen Annual Fair **	August 2-10
9 Lempster Old Home Day	August 9 9AM-2PM
10 Cornish Fair**	August 15-17
11 Newport Farmers' Market	Sept. 5 3PM-6PM
12 Fort at No. 4	September 20 10AM-4PM
13 Newport Block Party	September 26 4PM-7PM
14 Claremont Chili Cookoff/Fall Fest	October 4 10AM-3PM

**tabling was done not by AECOM

Town	Key Themes	Example Quotes
Claremont	Speeding & Enforcement; Sidewalk Gaps; Distracted Driving; E-Bike Concerns; Intersection Safety	"Washington Street feels like a raceway"; "Sidewalk missing on Charlestown Rd"; "Drivers on phones everywhere"



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Draft Project Locations - Countywide

PROJECT TYPE	PROJECT	COMMUNITY
Rural Intersection Safety Improvements	NH Route 11/12/12A (Claremont Road) at Lovers Lane Road	Charlestown
Commercial Corridor Safety Improvements	Washington Street Corridor	Claremont
Downtown Crossroads / Activity Center / Major Intersections	NH Route 10/11/103 (North Main Street/Main Street/Sunapee Street)/Park Street/Depot Street	Newport
	NH Route 10/11 (Main Street)	
	NH Route 10/11 (Main Street) / NH Route 10 (South Main Street)/ NH 103/11 (John Stark Highway/Elm Street)/Maple Street	

Draft Project Locations - Countywide

PROJECT TYPE	PROJECT	COMMUNITY
Downtown Activity Center, Urban Neighborhood Streets	NH Route 11 (West Pleasant Street, Pleasant Street), Summer Street, Mulberry Street	Claremont
	Broad Street (South Street to Water Street)	
Rural Roadways, Moderate Speed Limits	2nd NH Turnpike / Spooner Road	Unity
	NH Route 12A (Windsor Road) (from NH Route 12/103 to Windy Hill Road)	Claremont
	Acworth Road	Charlestown
Rural Roadways, Higher Speed Limits	NH Route 11 (Sargent Road to Jobs Creek Road)	Sunapee
	NH Route 103 (John Stark Highway) (Whitcher Road to Barton Whitney Road)	Newport
	NH Route 11/12/12A (Claremont Road) (Old Claremont Road to Ox Brook Road)	Charlestown
	NH Route 11/12/12A (Charlestown Road) (Charlestown T/L to Arch Road)	Claremont

Draft Project Locations - Claremont

PROJECT TYPE	PROJECT	COMMUNITY
Commercial Corridor Safety Improvements	Washington Street Corridor	Claremont
Urban Neighborhood Intersection	North Street/Elm Street	Claremont
Urban Neighborhood / Gateway Roadway	NH Route 12/103 (Main Street) (Citizen Street to Elm Street)	Claremont

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Draft Project Locations - Claremont

PROJECT - COMMUNITY	CURRENT OR PREVIOUS ACTIVITY
Washington Street Corridor, Claremont	Road Safety Audit (2011), Washington Street Signals Optimization Project (2025)
North Street/Elm Street - Claremont	NH Route 12 (Main Street) & North Street Improvements Project
NH Route 12/103 (Main Street) (Citizen Street to Elm Street) - Claremont	Claremont (NHDOT Project Number 43530): Roadway Reconstruction (Phase 1) of NH 103 from Citizen to West Street Intersections
NH Route 11 (West Pleasant Street, Pleasant Street, Summer Street, Mulberry Street – Claremont Broad Street (South Street to Water Street) - Claremont	Claremont (43726): Construct 1,400 LF of Sidewalk along Broad Street / Construct 1,950 LF of Pedestrian Path at Monadnock Park & Rail Trail UVLSRPC Tier II: Implement traffic calming, safety, and Complete Streets improvements along Broad St
NH Route 11/12/12A (Charlestown Road) (Charlestown T/L to Arch Road) - Claremont	Fitzwilliam-Claremont (28956): Safety Improvement Project to Install Sinusoidal Rumble Strips Charlestown (40667): Reconstruct or Rehabilitate NH 12 from NH 12A in southern Charlestown to Almar Street RAISE Grant (2024): Access, Restoration, Development and Safety (CARDS) Initiative The City of Claremont received a planning grant award to "prepare for the reconstruction of targeted sections of Charlestown Road, including new pedestrian facilities, sidewalks, bicycle lanes, curbs, new storm drains, culverts, sewer lines, and water lines. Full-scale execution of the project will result in the reconstruction of Charlestown Road and NH Route 11/NH Route 12 from Maple Avenue to River Road." UVLSRPC Tier I: Construct sidewalks, improve access management, and improve roadway condition along Charlestown Rd from Lane Ridge Rd to Highlandview Rd ; Add sidewalk along Charlestown Rd from Arch Rd to Buena Vista Rd.; Tier II: Intersection improvements at NH 11/Charlestown Rd and Grissom Ln.

Potential Proven Countermeasures by Project Type - Claremont

PROJECT TYPE	POTENTIAL PROVEN COUNTERMEASURES
Commercial Corridor Safety Improvements	Signal timing and phasing modifications, edge line improvements, centerline hardening, travel lane modifications, bike lane addition, access management
Urban Neighborhood Intersection	Sight distance improvements, review of directional signage placement / traffic control signage and pavement markings, sidewalk bulb-outs, parking modifications, roundabouts
Urban Neighborhood / Gateway Roadway	Advance intersection signage, speed limit reduction, speed feedback signs, traffic calming measures, bike and pedestrian improvements
Downtown Activity Center, Urban Neighborhood Streets	Traffic calming measures, installation of RRFBs, sidewalk bulb-outs, parking modifications, bike lane addition
Rural Roadways, Moderate Speed Limits	Speed limit reduction, speed feedback signs, pavement markings/edge lines/rumble strips, LED chevron signs, guardrails
Rural Roadways, Higher Speed Limits	Speed limit reduction, speed feedback signs, pavement markings/edge lines/rumble strips, center turn lanes, passing lanes, cross-section adjustments to accommodate bike lanes

Safety Action Plan Chapters

- Executive Summary
- Leadership Commitment and Goal Setting
- Planning Structure
- Safety Analysis
- Engagement and Collaboration
- Policy and Process Changes
- Strategy and Project Selection
- Progress and Transparency
- Appendices
- Crash Maps (Countywide and Individual Communities)

Safe Streets and Roads for All
4 A Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet

All applicants should follow the instructions in the NPOD to correctly apply for a grant. See the [SS4A website](#) for more information.

Table 1 of the [SS4A NPOD](#) describes [grant components of an Action Plan](#), which correspond to the questions in this worksheet. Applicants should use this worksheet to determine whether their existing plan(s) contains the required components to be considered an eligible Action Plan for SS4A.

This worksheet is required for all SS4A [Implementation Grant](#) applications and any [Planning and Demonstration Grant](#) applications to conduct [Supplemental Planning/Demonstration Activities](#) only. Please complete the form in its entirety, do not adjust the formatting or headings of the worksheet, and upload the completed PDF with your application.

Eligibility

An Action Plan is considered eligible for an SS4A application for an Implementation Grant or a Planning and Demonstration Grant to conduct Supplemental Planning/Demonstration Activities if the following two conditions are met:

- You can answer "YES" to Questions 3, 6, and 8 in this worksheet; and
- You can answer "YES" to at least three of the five remaining Questions, 1, 2, 4, 5, and 7.

If both conditions are not met, an applicant is still eligible to apply for a Planning and Demonstration Grant to fund the creation of a new Action Plan or updates to an existing Action Plan to meet SS4A requirements.

Applicant Information

Lead Applicant: _____ UIC: _____

Action Plan Documents

In the table below, list the relevant Action Plan and any additional plans or documents that you reference in this form. Up to three plans or documents may be included. Please provide a hyperlink to any documents available online or indicate that the Action Plan or other documents will be uploaded in Valid Form as part of your application. Note that, to be considered an eligible Action Plan for SS4A, the plan(s) coverage must be broader than just a corridor, neighborhood, or specific location.

Document Title	Link	Date of Most Recent Update

Follow-up: Leadership and Goal Setting

- Leadership Commitment (from an SS4A perspective):
- A high-ranking official and/or governing body in the jurisdiction publicly committed to an eventual goal of zero roadway fatalities and serious injuries
- The commitment includes either setting a target date to reach zero OR setting one or more targets to achieve a reduction in roadway fatalities and serious injuries by a specific date.
- Action item: develop a Vision Zero resolution for adoption by appropriate stakeholders, including the Sullivan County Commissioners
- Strategic Highway Safety Plan: Driving Toward Zero
 - UVLSRPC and the City of Claremont Department of Public Works are both Driving Toward Zero Coalition Members

Resolution No. _____

**A RESOLUTION OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF CLAREMONT, NH
ADOPTING A VISION ZERO POLICY**

PREAMBLE

The City of Claremont has engaged with the Sullivan County Commissioners and the New Hampshire Department of Transportation (NHDOT) to participate in the USDOT Safe Streets for All (SS4A) Program. As part of the SS4A Program, the County has developed a Safety Action Plan (SAP) with recommended safety improvements designed to reduce and eventually eliminate fatalities and serious injuries for all users of the roadway network within the boundaries of Sullivan County, including Claremont. This resolution serves as the City of Claremont's commitment to the principles of Vision Zero, the policy which is the basis of the Safe System Approach that underlies the SS4A Program.

WHEREAS, the life and health of all persons living and traveling within the City of Claremont are our utmost priority, and no one should die or be seriously injured while traveling on our local streets and roadways;

WHEREAS, Vision Zero is the concept that traffic deaths and serious injuries on our roadways are *unacceptable*;

WHEREAS, Vision Zero is a holistic strategy aimed at eliminating all traffic fatalities and severe injuries suffered by all road users while increasing safe, healthy, equitable mobility for all;

WHEREAS, streets and transportation systems have traditionally been designed primarily to move cars efficiently, and Vision Zero supports a paradigm shift by designing streets and transportation systems to move all people safely, including people of all ages and abilities, pedestrians, bicyclists, public transit users, scooter riders, and motorcyclists, as well as drivers and passengers of motor vehicles;

WHEREAS, Vision Zero recognizes that people will sometimes make mistakes, so the road system and related policies should be designed to ensure that those inevitable mistakes do not result in severe injuries or fatalities; therefore, transportation planners and engineers and policymakers are expected to improve the roadway environment, policies, and other related systems to lessen the severity of crashes;

WHEREAS, Zhang (1)crashes have resulted in a loss of life, and 26 have resulted in serious injury of the 1,417 crashes in the City of Claremont between 2019 and 2023, and traffic crashes are among the leading cause of deaths in the United States;

¹ Resolution based on a model policy provided by Changshu.org
² 10 leading causes of death, United States, 2020, both sexes, all ages, all races. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention website: www.cdc.gov/data/10-leads/



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SS4A Grant Opportunities 2026

- FY2026 Notice of Funding Opportunity likely in spring 2026, with 8-10 week application period**
- ALL Sullivan County communities are eligible for Planning and Demonstration Grants**
- Communities are only eligible for Implementation Grants if they have adopted a resolution to reduce and eliminate fatal and serious injuries by a target date**
- Planning and Demonstration Grants**
 - Planning and Demonstration Grants are used to develop, complete, or supplement an Action Plan.
 - Planning and Demonstration Grants also fund [supplemental safety planning activities](#) and [safety demonstration activities](#) in support of an Action Plan.
- Implementation Grants**
 - Implementation Grants are used to implement projects or strategies that are consistent with an existing Action Plan to address a roadway safety problem. Eligible projects and strategies can be infrastructural, behavioral, and/or operational activities.
 - Implementation Grants may also include [supplemental safety planning](#) and [safety demonstration activities](#) to inform an existing Action Plan, and project-level planning, design, and development activities.
 - Applicants must have an eligible [Action Plan](#) to apply for an Implementation Grant.



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Steering Committee Logistics

- Meeting Schedule
 - Monthly
 - Thursday at 2:30pm
 - February 2026 meeting will be February 19th
- Upcoming Meeting Topics
 - February: Draft SAP review and

Milestone	Schedule Date
Planned Draft Plan Completion Date	February 27, 2026
Planned Final Plan Completion Date	March 31, 2026
Planned Final Plan Adoption Date	April 22, 2026

Councilor Cogswell asked what the grant requirements are and if there is significant follow-up required. Mr. Derrig noted there are grant reporting requirements, like an annual update for crash statistics, and there will be an 80/20 split, the applicant would have to cover 20% without federal funds but a significant amount can be staff time.

By Consensus Council agreed to have the City Manager come back with a resolution for funding and a target date.

Resolution 2026-34 Wastewater Facility Study Grant – Public Hearing

Director Gleeson is requesting acceptance of \$100,000 from NHDES Clean Water State Revolving Fund with no matching requirements.

RESOLUTION 2026-34

Clean Water State Revolving Fund Loan

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS the Claremont Water Utilities Division would like to accept a grant from the New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services (NHDES) Clean Water State Revolving Fund for the amount of \$100,000.

WHEREAS these funds will be used to assist in the funding of the Waste Water Treatment Plant Facility Study.

WHEREAS the Clean Water State Revolving Fund, requires local government approval authorizing the loan agreement and requires no matching local funds.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake the acceptance of this loan and to approve the spending of these funds.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 11th day of March, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-34.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2026-34 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-35 DPW Lift Lease

Director Gleeson noted the current lift is about 15 years old, it poses safety concerns for staff and is seeking permission to move forward with a lease option and noted the first lease payment was already budgeted.

RESOLUTION 2026-35

DPW LEASE – VEHICLE LIFT

WHEREAS a vehicle lift at the Department of Public Works is scheduled to be replaced in 2026, with funds having been raised and appropriated therefore in the 2026 operating budget; and

WHEREAS the City is prepared to lease a vehicle lift for the Department of Public Works through a lease/purchase arrangement;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED, after public hearing duly noticed, that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to enter into a 4-year lease/purchase agreement in the principal amount of \$39,851.00 for the lease of Department of Public Works equipment, said costs, including interest, for the first annual payment of **\$11,473.62** having been raised and appropriated in the 2026 budget; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED the proposed lease agreement shall contain a termination clause in the event of non-appropriation of sufficient funds for any year subsequent to the first year of the agreement. (*Majority vote required*)

Dated this 11th day of March 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Cogswell and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept Resolution 2026-35.

Councilor Cogswell read Resolution 2026-35 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Treasurer Parks clarified the annual payment is \$11,473.62 and suggests amending the Resolution, both Councilor Cogswell and Greenrose accept the amendment.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

License Agreement for Map Lot 152-7

City Planner, Austin Ford noted Gary LeClair has had a license for agricultural use of this City owned parcel for 14 years, his most recent license is expiring and would like to renew for an additional two years.

Motion to Authorize License for Agricultural Use of City-Owned Property

The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to negotiate and enter into a License Agreement with Gary LeClair to use a portion of Parcel Map 152, Lot 7 for agricultural use for two (2) years, subject to payment of property taxes levied on Licensee's use of the property and subject to a provision that the license may be terminated, without penalty, if the City sells or otherwise develops the property.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to Authorize License for Agricultural Use of City-Owned Property.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-36 Moody Dog Park Walkway

Director Martin explained the surface leading into the dog park is grass and dirt and the biggest challenge is winter maintenance. Without a hard surface at the entrance, it collects mud and standing water. Director Martin is requesting to use the Dog Park Trust Fund to add a hard surface to the entrance of the dog park for improved safety, accessibility, and maintenance.

A motion was made by Councilor Irish and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-36.

Councilor Irish read Resolution 2026-36 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – no

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1

CSBCC Fitness Equipment Discussion (City Manager/Director of Parks and Recreation)

Director Martin explained the need to replace eleven pieces of fitness equipment with new equipment due to issues such as being out of warranty, high replacement part costs, and manufacturer discontinuation issues.

Councilor Limoges asked what these items would be replaced with and would support a Jacobs Ladder.

Councilor Greenrose asked what the life expectancy of the new equipment would be, and will be put into the bid process, Director Martin noted he could bring back this information.

Councilor Koloski asked if there was feedback from current members on what equipment they want and questioned if the equipment would be a lease with a buyout option.

Director Martin noted the plan at this time is to put out an RFP with all options such as a lease, a buyout, and lease with replacement equipment after a few years.

Mayor Giard asked if the Community Center is still in need for as much equipment even though the memberships have gone down.

Director Martin noted it would help to stay relevant, competitive, and show members the City is investing in the community and the facility.

Manager Bates accepted the input and will bring more information back. Manager Bates also noted there is a need to have a broader conversation about the Community Center.

Resolution 2026-37 Primex 2026 Workers Comp Invoice Budget Line Transfers

Treasurer Cathy Parks requests Council approval to adjust budget lines for the 2026 Primex workers' comp invoice due to unexpected classification changes, despite the total cost coming in \$1,789 under budget.

RESOLUTION 2026-37

Budget Line Transfers – Workers Compensation

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, the overall Fiscal Year 2026 budgeted amount for Workers Compensation insurance from Primex is \$217,154 and the actual invoice is \$215,365. However, several departmental budgets are negatively affected due to rate increases and a classification change for call firefighters created a favorable variance.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to make the following budget amendments:

\$404.00 from 001-416-416135-0000 to 001-411-411135-0000

\$932.00 from 001-414-414135-0000 to 001-415-415135-0000

\$29,921.00 from 001-422-422135-0000 to

001-421-421135-0000 in the amount of \$12,002.00

001-441-441135-0000 in the amount of \$13,110.00

001-481-481135-0000 in the amount of \$2,506.00

001-482-482135-0000 in the amount of \$2,303.00

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 11th day of March, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2026-37.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2026-37 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish - yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

City Hall Repairs Discussion

Manager Bates explained significant deterioration at City Hall due to age and deferred maintenance, with temporary fixes no longer sufficient. Manager Bates is requesting the Council to fund up to \$101,650 in urgent repairs to the City Hall entrance stairs, Opera House balcony ceiling, rear chimneys, and roof/gutter areas, based on an assessment by Valley Restoration LLC.

Councilor Irish doesn't want let this go, or use more band aid fixes.

Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees, and noted the City has a healthy fund balance, and the more its pushed off the more expensive it will be.

Councilor Cogswell asked how quickly the repairs could be made.

Manager Bates stated Valley Restoration can start soon and be done quickly.

By consensus Council agrees to have Manager Bates bring back a resolution for funding.

Naming City Property Discussion

Manager Bates is requesting Council approval to host a "Name a Truck" contest, allowing residents—especially youth—to help name new DPW plow trucks as part of the Celebrate Claremont July 4th celebration to boost community engagement.

By consensus Council agrees to move forward with name a truck.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Greenrose reported that the Conservation Commission is holding a snowshoe event at Stevens Brook this Sunday.

Assistant Mayor Matteau reported the Planning board had updates on the Master Plan, discussed the CIP process, and appointed City Planner Ford as an alternate to the Upper Valley Lake Sunapee Regional Planning Commission.

Councilor Koloski shared an update about the eagle donation for the Arts Committee.

Councilor Hemingway reported Zoning discussed Broad Street Housing Trust looking for a re-hearing which was denied, application for a variance for a 68-78 housing complex on Washington Street.

Councilor Irish noted the Procurement meetings are progressing really well and currently looking into software programs to offer opportunities to streamline.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski suggested planting a tree out front of City Hall where the tank was removed and name it after someone for the 250th celebration.

Councilor O’Hearne asked when Burr was re-starting construction and suggested putting signage out. Councilor O’Hearne also asked if Burr was responsible for filling potholes, and shared concern for a water drain that is capped off on Grandview and North.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:06 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council